

BLIZZARD

Employed by Stark Industries, Dr. Gregor Shapanka attempted to steal and sell Stark technology to fund research into longevity. After being caught and fired, Shapanka developed a suit capable of generating immense cold. Using it to perform acts of villainy, he came to be known as Jack Frost or Blizzard and became a nemesis of IRON MAN. Shapanka's life ended when he was killed by Arno Stark, the Iron Man of 2020 (from Earth-8410), who had come back in time for data needed to disarm a bomb. Shapanka's successor as Blizzard was Donny Gill, an employee of Justin Hammer (see HAMMER, JUSTIN).

After leaving Hammer's employ, he joined the MASTERS OF EVIL, and later he became a part of MACH-IV's THUNDERBOLTS. After earning a pardon for his crimes, he registered with the Fifty State Initiative (see pp. 118–9). A third man, Randy Macklin, wore Gill's suit for a while, but after he was captured and served his time, Tony Stark took him under his wing. **AD, MF**

Suit contains tiny cryogenic units called micro-cryostats.

The more water there is in the air, the more powerful is Blizzard's suit. In arid conditions it is useless.

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Dr. Gregor Shapanka

OCCUPATION

Former scientist; criminal

BASE

New York City

HEIGHT

5 ft 6 in

WEIGHT

165 lbs

EYES

Brown

HAIR

Brown

FIRST APPEARANCE

Tales of Suspense Vol. 1 #45
(September 1963)

Gloves on Blizzard's battlesuit could project intense cold, generate freezing mist, mini-blizzards of snow, sleet, and darts of ice that could pierce metal; he could freeze people by covering them in frost; escaped capture by creating an ice slide. He has no superhuman powers.

BLIZZARD

POWERS

BLOB

Once a carnival freak, life changed for Fred J. Dukes when the X-MEN revealed to him that he was a mutant. Rather than accept their offer of membership in their school, Dukes attempted to destroy them as the Blob. Recruited thereafter by MAGNETO to become a member of his BROTHERHOOD OF EVIL MUTANTS, the Blob embarked on a life of crime, clashing not only with the X-Men, but also with the AVENGERS and the DEFENDERS. For a while, he worked with the government-sponsored FREEDOM FORCE, but later returned to crime. After M-Day, the Blob lost his powers and much of his mass, but his skin did not snap back and hung on him in folds. Soon after, he joined X-Cell, a group of angry, depowered mutants. He's since lost the extra skin and is promoting himself as a weight-loss success story in Japan.

TB, MF

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Fred J. Dukes

OCCUPATION

Criminal; former circus performer

BASE

Mobile

HEIGHT

8 ft

WEIGHT

976 lbs

EYES

Brown

HAIR

Brown

FIRST APPEARANCE

Uncanny X-Men #3
(January 1964)

Superhuman strength and durability. Fatty body could absorb bullets, even artillery shells, and was impervious to injury; however eyes, ears, nose, and mouth were not as injury-resistant. When he planted himself firmly, the Blob bonded with the ground beneath him and could not be moved.

BLOB

POWERS

When the Blob set himself in one position, his mutant ability made it almost impossible for an outside force to dislodge him.